

Jolicloud - the most Cloud ready OS

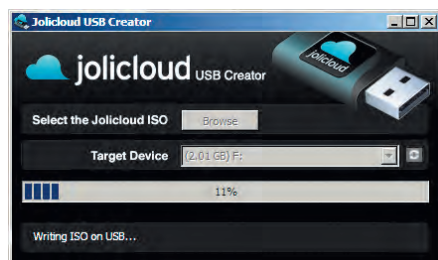
Aditya Madanapalle
 aditya.madanapalle@thinkdigit.com

Jolicloud is one of the most mature netbook operating systems we've seen, and it has borrowed the best elements from existing ones to create a fresh, innovative, and very comfortable OS for netbooks. It looks better than Moblin - is fast (but not as fast as Chrome), and has recently come out of closed Alpha testing. The version available now, and included on the DVD is a pre-beta release, so the OS is still pretty much in development. Despite the pre-beta tag, if you need an OS on your netbook that handles cloud applications as well as

when installed. The ISO file is an install disc, but acts as a Live CD as well, so that you can have a look at the OS without it leaving any footprints on your system. In the Live mode however, you cannot install applications.

The Windows install is called Jolicloud Express, double-click on the .exe file, and the installation starts. Jolicloud will treat the application as an OS within the wrapper, so you have to specify all the information as if you are setting up an actual OS. This includes a login name, a network name for the machine, and any proxy information that you might have.

The installation takes up 8 GB of space on your hard drive by default, but this can be changed using advanced options. Once installed, you can try out Jolicloud as just another window. To install the OS on a computer, you will have to burn the ISO image as a bootable disc using a CD burning application such as MagicDisc. Once burnt, insert the CD into the tray, and restart the machine. Hit the [F12] button during load time to get the boot menu, and select Boot from DVD Drive. If you have multiple media drives installed, choose the drive with the CD in it. You can then either choose to install Jolicloud right away, or start a Live CD session on the desktop. If installing along-



Using the USB creator to make a USB drive installer

desktop ones, Jolicloud is something you should try out, and we expect you to love it.

Installing Jolicloud

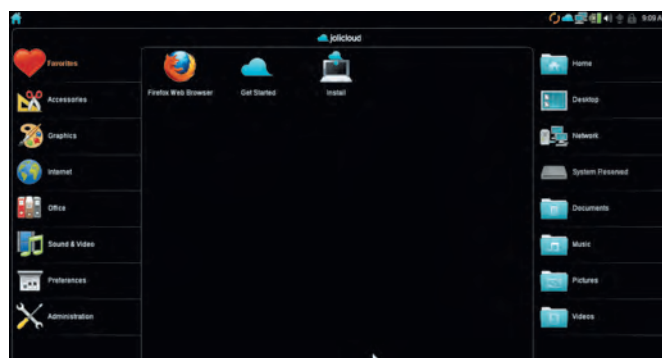
The installation process is very simple. If you prefer to run it as an application on your Windows desktop, then Jolicloud offers the OS wrapped in a virtual machine, that you can run from a window. This is an EXE file, which is more or less what the OS has to offer

when installed. The ISO file is an install disc, but acts as a Live CD as well, so that you can have a look at the OS without it leaving any footprints on your system. In the Live mode however, you cannot install applications.

The Windows install is called Jolicloud Express, double-click on the .exe file, and the installation starts. Jolicloud will treat the application as an OS within the wrapper, so you have to specify all the information as if you are setting up an actual OS. This includes a login name, a network name for the machine, and any proxy information that you might have.

The installation takes up 8 GB of space on your hard drive by default, but this can be changed using advanced options. Once installed, you can try out Jolicloud as just another window. To install the OS on a computer, you will have to burn the ISO image as a bootable disc using a CD burning application such as MagicDisc. Once burnt, insert the CD into the tray, and restart the machine. Hit the [F12] button during load time to get the boot menu, and select Boot from DVD Drive. If you have multiple media drives installed, choose the drive with the CD in it. You can then either choose to install Jolicloud right away, or start a Live CD session on the desktop. If installing along-

side Windows OS, or another OS, you will have to choose to make space for Jolicloud in the same partition as Windows. Be careful in this step, and backup important data as choosing to use an entire hard disc will wipe the Windows install, and all your data with it.



The Jolicloud dashboard

side Windows OS, or another OS, you will have to choose to make space for Jolicloud in the same partition as Windows. Be careful in this step, and backup important data as choosing to use an entire hard disc will wipe the Windows install, and all your data with it.

If your netbook does not have a DVD drive, then you can choose to install Jolicloud using a USB drive. For this, you will need an application that converts a USB drive into a bootable device, using the Jolicloud image file. You will find this application on the DVD as well. You will first need to install Jolicloud USB creator installer on your system, then run the USB creator. You will also need a USB drive that has more than a GB of space. Be sure to backup any files that you have on the USB drive, as the installation process will wipe the drive clean before creating the installable drive. Start up the USB creator, and locate the ISO image for the Jolicloud installation. Then, locate the USB drive from the dropdown box.

If there is only one USB drive connected to the machine, that one will be selected automatically. To be safe, be sure to disconnect any external memory that you may have. Your USB drive won't be recognised as a regular memory drive on your Windows machine once the USB creator is through with it, and Windows may prompt for a format, ignore this prompt. Insert the USB drive in the netbook, hit [F12] and select USB hard disk to boot and install Jolicloud. Before the USB drive is usable again, you will have to format it.

Setup and optimisation

The dashboard is fresh and functional. The applications are listed on the right, and links to important system folders are listed along the left. Jolicloud offers a great middle ground between the traditional desktop based interface, as well as a cloud OS running from the web. By default, Jolicloud uses Mozilla Prism for running all the web applications, where